Drawdown

POCKET REFERENCE

COLOR CORRECTION GUIDE FOR PRINTERS & PREPRESS OPERATORS

drawdown.press

ΔE 2000 LADDER / WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

Visual risk staircase meter

- < 1.0 | Dead match. Don't chase it.
- 1-2 | Commercial match. Most jobs pass here.
- 2-3.5 | Visible side by side. Correct if the client will see both.
- > 3.5 | The client will see it. Correct before you run the job.

COMMON DRIFT (vs. target) — WHAT TO MOVE

when your Lab reading drifts, the fix is almost always one ink

	FIRST MOVE	IF STILL OFF
+a (too red)	pull magenta	or add a touch of cyan
-a (too green)	pull cyan	or add a touch of magenta
+b (too yellow)	pull yellow	or add magenta on warm stock
-b (too blue)	pull cyan	or add a touch of yellow
-L (too dark)	pull K first	then pull all four if still heavy
+L (too light)	add CMY proportional	K last, sparingly

FIRST, CHECK THE MATERIAL

(the paper or substrate)

You are not printing on white. Every substrate shifts the color on it. Before you blame the build, measure the bare stock. If it's cyan, you can't hit warm colors by piling on more ink. No amount of yellow fixes a cyan substrate.

Diagnose where the cast lives first.

GRAY BALANCE BUILDS

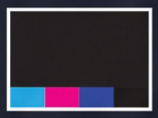
common neutral CMY targets by paper

25 50 75 VS 25 50 75

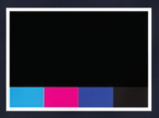
	COATED (GRACOL)	UNCOATED
25%	C 25 / M 19 / Y 19	C 25 / M 18 / Y 18
50%	C 50 / M 40 / Y 40	C 50 / M 43 / Y 43
75%	C 75 / M 64 / Y 64	C 75 / M 68 / Y 68

CMYK RECIPES — COMMON BLACKS & GRAYS

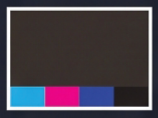
when K-only isn't enough or the gray needs a temperature



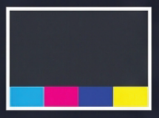
RICH BLACK
60/40/40/100
deeper than K-only



SUPER BLACK
75/68/67/100
max density



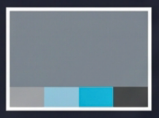
WARM BLACK
40/60/40/100
shifts shadow warmer



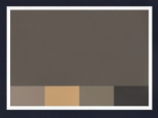
COOL BLACK
70/50/30/100
shifts shadow cooler



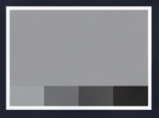
WARM GRAY 50
40/45/50/10
yellow-shifted



COOL GRAY 50
55/45/40/10
cyan-shifted



RICH WARM GRAY
40/50/55/25
deep warm neutral



3-COLOR GRAY
40/32/32/0
no K. photo-clean

SPECTRO MEASUREMENT CONDITIONS

pick one and stick with it across all readings

M0 — **No UV filtering.** Legacy only use when matching old M0 data.

M1 — **D50 with controlled UV.** Standard for wide-format and sign work with OBAs.

M2 — **UV excluded entirely.** Compare colors without optical brightener effect.

VIEWING



at 5000K, ~2000 lux, neutral surround (ISO 3664).

Your eye lies under warm office light.

GOT A DRIFT? CLOSE IT.

Enter your target, what's on the printer, and your material. Drawdown returns the exact CMYK moves.

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